

Grammar

Should have / Could have (criticism and regret about the past)

We use **should have + past participle** to criticise a past action that did not happen but would have been the right thing to do. We use **shouldn't have + past participle** to criticise something that did happen but was the wrong thing to do. We use **could have + past participle** to talk about a possible action in the past that was not taken.

*Geçmişte yapılmayan ama yapılması gereken bir davranışı eleştirmek için **should have + fiil3** kullanılır.*

*Geçmişte yapılan ama yapılmaması gereken bir davranışı eleştirmek için **shouldn't have + fiil3** kullanılır.*

*Geçmişte mümkün olduğu hâlde yapılmayan bir eylemden bahsetmek için ise **could have + fiil3** kullanılır.*

When? Use this structure when giving advice about the past, expressing regret, or criticising a decision that cannot be changed anymore.

Geçmişle ilgili tavsiye verirken, pişmanlık ifade ederken veya artık değiştirilemeyecek bir kararı eleştirirken bu yapı kullanılır.

Positive

- Subject + **should/could + have + past participle**
- You **should have** listened to her.

Negative

- Subject + **shouldn't/couldn't + have + past participle**
- You **shouldn't have** said that.

Question

- **Should/Could + subject + have + past participle?**
- **Should I have** called him first?

Short answers

- **Yes, you should have. / No, you shouldn't have.**

Common mistakes

- ~~You should have went to the doctor.~~ → **You should have gone to the doctor.**
- ~~I should to have called her.~~ → **I should have called her.**

1. You _____ so rude to your classmate yesterday.

- a. shouldn't have been
- b. shouldn't be
- c. don't have to be
- d. can't be

2. She _____ (apologise) right away, but she waited two days.

3. 'I should studied harder for the exam.' is a correct sentence. — *True / False*

4. Which sentence expresses regret about something NOT done?

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- a. You shouldn't have shouted.
- b. I should have called her.
- c. He shouldn't have left early.
- d. They shouldn't have lied.

5. Rewrite using could have: It was possible for him to ask for help, but he didn't. (He ____)

6. Put the words in order: have / you / shouldn't / that / said

7. We _____ (not / assume) she was angry; we never asked her.

8. Choose the sentence with the correct meaning: 'You could have texted me.'

- a. It was necessary for you to text me.
- b. It was possible for you to text me, but you didn't.
- c. You definitely texted me.
- d. You are texting me now.

9. Rewrite as criticism using shouldn't have: It was wrong of them to hold a grudge for so long. (They ____)

Might have / Must have / Couldn't have (degrees of certainty about the past)

We use must have + past participle when we are almost certain about a past event based on evidence. We use might have + past participle when we are not sure and are only guessing at a possibility. We use couldn't have + past participle when we are certain something was impossible in the past.

Geçmişte olan bir olay hakkında kanıtlara dayanarak neredeyse emin olduğumuzda must have + fiil3 kullanılır. Emin olmadığımız, sadece bir olasılığı tahmin ettiğimiz durumlarda might have + fiil3 kullanılır. Geçmişte bir şeyin imkânsız olduğundan emin olduğumuzda ise couldn't have + fiil3 kullanılır.

When? Use this structure when speculating about a past event, explaining evidence, or ruling out an impossible explanation.

Geçmişteki bir olay hakkında tahminde bulunurken, kanıtları açıklarken veya imkânsız bir açıklamayı elerken bu yapı kullanılır.

Positive

- Subject + must/might + have + past participle
- He must have left early.

Negative

- Subject + might not/couldn't + have + past participle
- She couldn't have known that.

Question

- Rarely used in questions; guesses are usually expressed as statements: 'Do you think she might have forgotten?'

Short answers

- She might have. / No, she couldn't have.

Common mistakes

- ~~He must have went home.~~ → **He must have gone home.**
- ~~She can't have knew about it.~~ → **She couldn't have known about it.**

1. The door is locked and no lights are on. They _____ home yet.

- a. mustn't have gone
- b. can't have gone
- c. must have gone
- d. might have gone

2. I'm not sure, but she _____ (forget) our plans.

3. 'He couldn't have seen us; he was on the other side of the city.' expresses certainty that something was impossible. — *True / False*

4. Which modal expresses the strongest certainty about a past event?

- a. might have
- b. could have (possibility)
- c. must have
- d. may have

5. Rewrite to express impossibility: It's impossible that she said that. (*She* ____)

6. Put the words in order: have / must / been / it / difficult

7. Choose the sentence that best expresses an uncertain guess about the past.

- a. He must have left already.
- b. He couldn't have left already.
- c. He might have left already.
- d. He has left already.

8. They _____ (not / hear) us; the music was too loud.